

# Buy-Side Equity Terminal

Competitive Research, Market Opportunity & Technical Architecture

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*This document covers the competitive landscape for Bloomberg Terminal alternatives, validates the market opportunity, quantifies API costs, and provides a full technical architecture for the Regapps Buy-Side Equity Terminal (Bet 1 strategy).*

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# The Shift Is Already Happening

Bloomberg Terminal has operated as an unchallenged institutional monopoly for over 40 years, peaking at ~325,000 subscriptions globally and generating over \$10B in annual revenue. But 2025 marked a clear inflection point.

| Statistic                                                         | Finding |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------|---------|
| Hedge funds planning to reduce Bloomberg seats (18-month horizon) | 34%     |
| Institutions that have already migrated to an alternative         | 18%     |
| Institutions actively evaluating Bloomberg alternatives           | 52%     |
| Primary driver: cost                                              | 67%     |
| Secondary driver: desire for modern UX & remote access            | 45%     |

Source: 2025 survey of 500+ institutional traders (Godel Terminal)

## Why Bloomberg Is Vulnerable Now

- **Cost escalation outpacing value:** A 10-person hedge fund at \$500M AUM pays \$276,600/year to a single software vendor — more than legal, compliance, or accounting combined.
- **Antiquated UX:** Windows-only desktop app requiring local installation, dedicated keyboard hardware, no real mobile app, and a function-key interface designed in the 1990s.
- **Cloud-native gap:** Competitors are browser-based, instant-on, and accessible anywhere. Bloomberg Anywhere is severely limited vs. the desktop.
- **AI lag:** Bloomberg only launched its first generative AI feature (Document Search & Analysis) in late 2025 — years after startups had already built AI-native workflows.
- **Not built for discovery:** Bloomberg is built for lookups. Modern analysts need trend detection, cross-signal analysis, and surfacing anomalies before you know to look for them.

**OPPORTUNITY VERDICT:** The window is open. 34% of institutions are actively planning to reduce Bloomberg seats within 18 months. The TAM is real, the pain is documented, and no single challenger has captured the mid-market buy-side equity segment cleanly.

## 2 · COMPETITIVE LANDSCAPE

### Tier 1: Legacy Giants (Direct Competitors)

| Product                            | Strength                                                | Weakness                                                         | Price/Seat/Yr       | Target              |
|------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------|---------------------|
| Bloomberg Terminal                 | Everything — depth, breadth, chat network, fixed income | Price, antiquated UX, Windows-only, no AI-native workflow        | \$27,000+           | All institutions    |
| Refinitiv Eikon / Workspace (LSEG) | FX data best-in-class, multi-asset                      | Still expensive, converging products confusing users             | \$3,600–\$22,000    | Banks, buy-side     |
| FactSet Workstation                | Fundamentals, Excel plugin, sell-side modeling staple   | No real-time trading data, limited AI, expensive for small firms | \$12,000–\$20,000 + | Equity research, PM |
| S&P; Capital IQ                    | Private market data, IB/PE workflows, web-based         | Not a general terminal replacement, no real-time market data     | \$30,000+/yr        | IB, PE, credit      |

### Tier 2: Modern Challengers (Most Relevant Competitors)

| Product                 | Users / ARR                                                          | Price                 | Strength                                                            | Gap vs. Your Product                                                  |
|-------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Koyfin                  | 500k+ users, \$3.9M ARR (2025), \$6.7M raised                        | \$0–\$299/mo          | Clean UI, global equity + macro, strong retail traction             | Retail-skewed, not keyboard-driven, no institutional workflow         |
| OpenBB                  | 131k users, 55k GitHub stars, \$8.5M seed                            | Free / Enterprise     | Open source, modular, 'Financial OS', SOC 2 (2025)                  | DIY-heavy, no hosted SaaS polish for non-developers                   |
| Fiscal.ai (fka FinChat) | 350k users, 70+ institutional API clients, \$10M Series A (Jun 2025) | Freemium + enterprise | AI-native filings & earnings analysis, VanEck as strategic investor | Research/chat focused — not a full terminal with live data & charting |
| TradingView             | 50M+ users                                                           | \$15–\$60/mo          | Best charting in class, massive community                           | Not institutional — no fundamentals, no earnings, no workflow         |
| Tikr Terminal           | ~100k users                                                          | \$20–\$65/mo          | Deep buy-side equity data, 13F tracking                             | No macro, no news, no live prices, no AI layer                        |
| Finster AI              | Tier 1 bank pilots, \$15M raised (Oct 2025)                          | Enterprise only       | Front-office AI workflows, MNPI-safe, IB focus                      | Investment banking focus, not buy-side equity research                |

### Competitive Gap Analysis

After mapping every competitor, one specific profile remains unoccupied:

| Capability                             | Koyfin  | OpenBB     | Fiscal.ai  | TradingView | YOUR PRODUCT    |
|----------------------------------------|---------|------------|------------|-------------|-----------------|
| Keyboard-driven terminal UX            | ✗       | ✓ (CLI)    | ✗          | ✗           | ✓               |
| Institutional-grade fundamentals       | ✓       | ✓          | Partial    | ✗           | ✓               |
| Live price charts (LW Charts)          | ✓       | ✓          | ✗          | ✓✓          | ✓               |
| AI-native query layer                  | ✗       | Partial    | ✓✓         | ✗           | ✓✓              |
| 13F / Ownership intelligence           | Partial | Partial    | ✗          | ✗           | ✓✓ (head start) |
| Earnings + news feed                   | ✓       | ✓          | ✓✓         | ✗           | ✓               |
| Institutional pricing tier             | ✗       | Enterprise | Enterprise | ✗           | ✓               |
| DES / GP / FA Bloomberg-style commands | Partial | Partial    | ✗          | ✗           | ✓               |

**COMPETITIVE VERDICT:** The combination of keyboard-driven Bloomberg-style UX + AI query layer + 13F ownership intelligence + institutional pricing in a single modern web platform does not exist today. This is your moat.

### 3 · MARKET SIZING & FINANCIAL PROJECTIONS

#### Target Market Segments

| Segment                            | Est. Institutions (US) | Avg. Seats   | Bloomberg Pain       | Switching Likelihood |
|------------------------------------|------------------------|--------------|----------------------|----------------------|
| Hedge funds <\$500M AUM            | ~4,000                 | 2–10         | Extreme (>\$270k/yr) | High                 |
| RIAs & family offices              | ~15,000                | 1–5          | Very High            | Very High            |
| Regional & community banks         | ~2,000                 | 5–20         | High                 | Medium-High          |
| Boutique investment banks          | ~800                   | 3–15         | High                 | Medium               |
| University finance depts           | ~500                   | Lab licenses | Extreme              | Very High            |
| Independent analysts & consultants | ~50,000 individuals    | 1            | Can't afford BBG     | Instant              |

#### Revenue Model & Projections

| Tier          | Price          | Target Buyer                                  | Features                                                              |
|---------------|----------------|-----------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Free          | \$0/mo         | Students, indie analysts (acquisition funnel) | Delayed data, 2yr history, 2 watchlists, basic charts                 |
| Professional  | \$149/mo       | Independent analysts, small family offices    | Real-time data, 10yr history, all Bloomberg-style screens, AI queries |
| Institutional | \$499/mo/seat  | Hedge funds, RIAs, boutique banks             | Everything + portfolio tools, alerts, multi-seat SSO, API access      |
| Enterprise    | \$999+/mo/seat | Multi-desk firms                              | Custom onboarding, compliance export, dedicated support, SLA          |

| Milestone      | Timeline | Seats | Avg MRR/Seat | MRR       | ARR       |
|----------------|----------|-------|--------------|-----------|-----------|
| MVP Launch     | Month 6  | 50    | \$99         | \$5,000   | \$60,000  |
| Early Traction | Month 12 | 250   | \$199        | \$50,000  | \$600,000 |
| Growth         | Month 18 | 600   | \$299        | \$179,000 | \$2.1M    |
| Scale          | Month 24 | 1,500 | \$350        | \$525,000 | \$6.3M    |
| Institutional  | Month 36 | 4,000 | \$400        | \$1.6M    | \$19.2M   |

**REVENUE VERDICT:** At 1,500 seats (Month 24), you reach \$6.3M ARR — a fundable, acquirable business. This requires capturing less than 0.4% of the addressable US mid-market. Bloomberg charges one hedge fund \$270k/year. You displace that at \$72k/year/10-seat desk.

## 4 · API COST ANALYSIS

### Recommended API Stack — Tier 1 MVP

| API Provider                  | What It Covers                                              | Plan         | Cost/Mo  | Notes                                          |
|-------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------|--------------|----------|------------------------------------------------|
| Polygon.io                    | Real-time US equities, options chains, forex, crypto        | Starter      | \$79     | WebSocket streaming included                   |
| Financial Modeling Prep (FMP) | Financials (IS/BS/CF), ratios, DCF, estimates, peers        | Professional | \$49     | Global coverage, 250 req/min                   |
| Benzinga Pro API              | Breaking financial news, earnings releases, analyst ratings | Professional | \$99     | Best-in-class financial news latency           |
| FRED API (Federal Reserve)    | 800k+ US macro series, economic calendar                    | Free         | \$0      | No rate limits worth worrying about            |
| World Bank / IMF API          | Global macro — GDP, inflation, trade data                   | Free         | \$0      | REST APIs, no key required                     |
| SEC EDGAR API                 | 13F filings, 8-K, 10-K, insider transactions                | Free         | \$0      | Your 13F Copilot pipeline already handles this |
| NewsAPI                       | 80k+ news sources as supplementary feed                     | Business     | \$99     | Good for non-financial news context            |
| Open Exchange Rates           | FX rates, currency conversion                               | Developer    | \$12     | Hourly updates sufficient for MVP              |
| CoinGecko API                 | Crypto prices, market cap, DeFi data                        | Analyst      | \$0–\$49 | Free tier sufficient for most use cases        |

| Phase             | APIs Active                         | Monthly API Cost | Target MRR | API as % of Revenue |
|-------------------|-------------------------------------|------------------|------------|---------------------|
| MVP (Month 1-6)   | Polygon + FMP + Benzinga + FRED/SEC | \$339            | \$5,000    | 6.8%                |
| Growth (Month 12) | All above + NewsAPI + FX + Crypto   | \$538            | \$50,000   | 1.1%                |
| Scale (Month 24)  | All above + Intrinio for depth      | \$900–\$1,500    | \$525,000  | <0.3%               |

**COST VERDICT:** MVP API cost is \$339/month. At 50 paying users at \$99 each (\$4,950 MRR), you are already API-cost-positive from the first cohort. This is a highly capital-efficient business — not a data cost nightmare.

### Future Upgrade APIs (Post-Product-Market-Fit)

| API                    | What It Adds                                     | Cost/Mo  | When to Add                    |
|------------------------|--------------------------------------------------|----------|--------------------------------|
| Intrinio Fundamentals  | Deeper global fundamentals, cleaner data quality | \$300    | Month 12+                      |
| Polygon Options (Full) | Greeks, IV surface, options analytics            | \$199    | When options screen is built   |
| Refinitiv News (LSEG)  | Institutional-grade news, analyst research       | \$500+   | Enterprise tier only           |
| Visible Alpha          | Consensus earnings estimates (sell-side)         | \$500+   | Institutional tier only        |
| ICE Bond Data          | Corporate bond pricing, TRACE data               | \$1,000+ | If you add fixed income screen |



## 5 · BUILD DECISION — IS IT WORTH IT?

| Factor                               | Assessment                                                                        | Signal     |
|--------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------|
| Market timing                        | 34% of institutions planning to reduce Bloomberg seats in 18 months               | ✓ GO       |
| Competitor gap                       | No product combines BBG-style UX + AI + 13F intelligence in mid-market            | ✓ GO       |
| API cost vs revenue                  | \$339/mo APIs vs. \$5k+ MRR from 50 users = profitable from day 1                 | ✓ GO       |
| Existing asset leverage              | 13F Copilot = live data pipeline, Sculptor context, D.Boral intro                 | ✓ GO       |
| Build complexity                     | Hard but buildable with Claude Code in 8-10 weeks for MVP                         | ✓ GO       |
| Sales motion                         | Freemium to self-serve — low CAC, no enterprise sales team needed at launch       | ✓ GO       |
| Defensibility                        | 13F intelligence + AI query layer = proprietary moat competitors can't clone fast | ✓ GO       |
| Risk: Bloomberg AI catch-up          | BBG launched first AI feature Nov 2025 — they are behind, not ahead               | ■ WATCH    |
| Risk: Fiscal.ai / Koyfin competition | Neither has keyboard-driven BBG workflow or 13F intelligence                      | ■ WATCH    |
| Risk: Data quality at scale          | FMP data quality degrades for smaller international companies                     | ■ MITIGATE |

## VERDICT: BUILD IT

The market is moving, the gap is real, the API costs are manageable, and you have an existing data asset (13F Copilot) that no competitor has. The risk/reward is strongly positive. The only question is execution speed — and Claude Code solves that.

## 6 · TECHNICAL ARCHITECTURE

### Product Name Suggestion: APEX Terminal

Tagline: *Institutional-grade market intelligence. Not \$27,000.*

Built on your existing Regapps stack: Node.js/TypeScript, Hono, Supabase/PostgreSQL, Drizzle ORM, React/Vite, Claude API with tool use.

### System Architecture Overview

| Layer          | Technology                        | Purpose                                        |
|----------------|-----------------------------------|------------------------------------------------|
| Frontend       | React + Vite + TypeScript         | Terminal UI, command bar, chart screens        |
| Charts         | Lightweight Charts (TV)           | GP, GPC, candlestick, multi-timeframe          |
| API Gateway    | Hono (Node.js/TS)                 | Route all client requests, auth, rate limiting |
| Real-time      | WebSocket server (ws/Hono)        | Live price streaming from Polygon              |
| AI Query Layer | Claude API (tool use)             | SIMPLE → PLANNED → AGENT query routing         |
| Data Cache     | Redis (Upstash)                   | 15-min price cache, session state              |
| Database       | Supabase PostgreSQL               | Users, watchlists, portfolios, 13F data        |
| ORM            | Drizzle ORM                       | Type-safe DB access                            |
| Auth           | Supabase Auth + JWT               | SSO, multi-seat, role-based access             |
| Infra          | Vercel (frontend) + Railway (API) | Same as 13F Copilot — zero ops overhead        |
| Payments       | Stripe                            | Subscription billing, seat management          |

### Core Bloomberg-Style Screens — MVP

| Screen                   | Bloomberg Equiv. | Data Source              | Priority |
|--------------------------|------------------|--------------------------|----------|
| Security Description     | DES              | FMP + Polygon + SEC      | P0       |
| Price Chart              | GP               | Polygon WebSocket + REST | P0       |
| Financial Statements     | FA               | FMP (IS/BS/CF)           | P0       |
| News Feed                | NI / NEWS        | Benzinga + NewsAPI       | P0       |
| Watchlist + Live Tickers | RPRT / WPG       | Polygon WebSocket        | P0       |
| Peer Comparison Chart    | GPC              | Polygon + FMP            | P1       |

|                            |                |                                  |    |
|----------------------------|----------------|----------------------------------|----|
| Relative Valuation Table   | RV             | FMP ratios                       | P1 |
| Equity Screener            | EQS            | FMP + Polygon screener           | P1 |
| 13F Ownership Intelligence | OWN (BBG)      | SEC EDGAR (13F Copilot pipeline) | P1 |
| Earnings Calendar          | EVTS           | FMP earnings calendar            | P1 |
| Macro Dashboard            | ECOW / WEI     | FRED + World Bank                | P2 |
| Options Overview           | OMON           | Polygon options                  | P2 |
| AI Research Query          | (no BBG equiv) | Claude API + all sources         | P1 |

### The Keyboard Command System

This is the single most important UX feature. Bloomberg users are trained on command-driven workflows. Replicating this creates immediate familiarity and differentiation from Koyfin/TradingView.

| Command                  | Action                                 | Implementation                                |
|--------------------------|----------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------|
| DES AAPL                 | Load Apple security description screen | Route parser → DES component with ticker=AAPL |
| GP MSFT 1Y               | Show Microsoft 1-year price chart      | Route → GP with ticker + timeframe params     |
| FA NVDA                  | Show Nvidia financial statements       | Route → FA component with FMP data            |
| GPC AAPL MSFT GOOG       | Peer comparison chart                  | Multi-ticker GP with overlay                  |
| NI TSLA                  | News for Tesla                         | Benzinga filtered by ticker                   |
| OWN AAPL                 | 13F institutional ownership            | 13F Copilot data layer                        |
| EQS                      | Open equity screener                   | FMP screener UI                               |
| MOST                     | Most active / top movers               | Polygon market movers                         |
| ECOW                     | Economic calendar                      | FRED upcoming releases                        |
| /ask Who is buying NVDA? | AI natural language query              | Claude API agent with 13F + price tools       |

### AI Query Architecture — 3-Tier System

Reuse your existing 13F Copilot 3-tier query architecture: SIMPLE → PLANNED COMPLEX → AGENT LOOP. Expand the tool set from 13F-specific to full-market.

| Tier | Trigger | Example Query | Tools Available |
|------|---------|---------------|-----------------|
|------|---------|---------------|-----------------|

|                    |                              |                                                              |                                                          |
|--------------------|------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------|
| SIMPLE             | Single entity, one data type | 'What is Apple's P/E ratio?'                                 | get_fundamentals, get_price                              |
| PLANNED<br>COMPLEX | Multi-step, single answer    | 'Compare FAANG valuations vs 5yr avg'                        | get_fundamentals, get_peers, get_historical, calc_ratios |
| AGENT<br>LOOP      | Open-ended research          | 'Who are the top buyers of semiconductor stocks in Q1 2025?' | All tools + 13F pipeline + news + screener               |

## 7 · BUILD ROADMAP

| Phase                    | Timeline    | Deliverables                                                                                | Go-Live Criteria                            |
|--------------------------|-------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------|
| Phase 1: Foundation      | Weeks 1-3   | Command bar parser, routing system, auth/Stripe skeleton, Polygon WebSocket connection      | Type a ticker and it routes correctly       |
| Phase 2: Core Screens    | Weeks 4-6   | DES, GP (Lightweight Charts), FA (FMP), NI (Benzinga news feed), Watchlist with live prices | Full DES → GP → FA → NI workflow functional |
| Phase 3: AI Layer        | Week 7      | Claude API integration, 3-tier query router, tool definitions for all data sources          | /ask queries return accurate answers        |
| Phase 4: 13F Integration | Week 8      | OWN screen, institutional flow analysis, SEC filing ingestion (reuse 13F Copilot pipeline)  | OWN AAPL shows top holders, recent changes  |
| Phase 5: Growth Screens  | Weeks 9-10  | GPC, RV, EQS screener, earnings calendar, macro dashboard (FRED)                            | All P1 screens complete                     |
| Phase 6: Polish & Launch | Weeks 11-12 | Mobile responsiveness, keyboard shortcut help, onboarding flow, free tier limits, billing   | Public launch, Product Hunt post            |

### Your Unfair Advantages

- **13F Copilot pipeline already built:** The SEC ingestion, CUSIP resolution, filer data, and 9-stage pipeline are done. OWN screen = plug existing work into new UI.
- **Sculptor Capital context:** You work at a hedge fund. You know exactly what buy-side analysts need and the language they speak. This is rare for a solo founder.
- **D. Boral (sell-side COO) demo:** You have an existing warm institutional contact for early feedback and potential first institutional client.
- **Claude Code velocity:** Your workflow already ships production-quality features in days, not weeks. Competitors with larger teams don't move faster than you.
- **Regapps stack is production-proven:** Vercel + Railway + Supabase is already battle-tested on 13F Copilot. No infra learning curve.

## 8 · RECOMMENDED NEXT STEPS

1. Name the product and register the domain. Suggested: **apexterminal.io** or **meridian.finance**
2. Spin up Polygon.io and FMP free trials today — validate data quality before committing to paid plans.
3. Build the command bar router in a single Claude Code session — this is the skeleton everything hangs on.
4. Port the 13F Copilot data layer into the new repo as a shared internal package.
5. Schedule the D. Boral demo for feedback on the DES + OWN screens — before spending months on polish.
6. Launch a waitlist landing page at Week 4 to start building a list while building the product.

